

LESSON 1.2: Users and Trading Partners

What this lesson is about

This lesson describes about the Sterling File Gateway users, communities, groups, and partners. It also lists the procedure to create communities, groups, partners, and users and to list built-in users of Sterling File Gateway.

What you should be able to do

- Explain the importance of users in Sterling File Gateway.
- List built in users of Sterling File Gateway.
- Explain about communities, groups and trading partners.
- Create communities, groups, partners and users.

How you will check your progress

The progress of the course is analyzed based on the successful application of the hands-on exercises.

Additional References

Documentation

- Sterling File Gateway user account:
http://www.ibm.com/support/knowledgecenter/SS4TGX_2.2.0/com.ibm.help.sfg_sys_admin.doc/sfg_createuseraccts.html?lang=en.
 - Regular expression:
<http://www.regular-expressions.info/>
-

Users

Introduction

User is an entity encompassed with authority to use partial or complete features of the system. User account is an entity encompassed with permission to access features, folders, files of the system.

In Sterling File Gateway, multiple users are described as user accounts. Inherently, each user account has different access levels and may have different landing pages in Sterling File Gateway as per their permissions.

There are five different user accounts in Sterling File Gateway:

User account	Description
System Administrator	installs and maintains system software. He can create initial users and configure services and adapters for sending and receiving files.
Integration Architect	creates, manages, and deletes partner groups, routing channel templates, producer file structures, and consumer file structures.
Route Provisioner	creates and manages partners, group membership, and routing channels.
Operator	monitors system status and file activity. Troubleshoots problems with partner activity, generates reports, uses logs, and subscribes for their own notifications.
Partner User	uploads and downloads files from myfilegateway. Can monitor Partner user's transactional activity. Partner user can subscribe to the notifications about the transactional activities, manage their password, and generate reports.

Administrative user

The *System Administrator*, *Integration Architect*, *Route Provisioner*, and *Operator* users are considered to be administrative users and members of Sterling File Gateway to manage file transfer business needs.

Partner user

The *Partner User* is not a member Sterling File Gateway. The *Partner User* is a member of a trading partner company and has access only to myfilegateway.

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Users

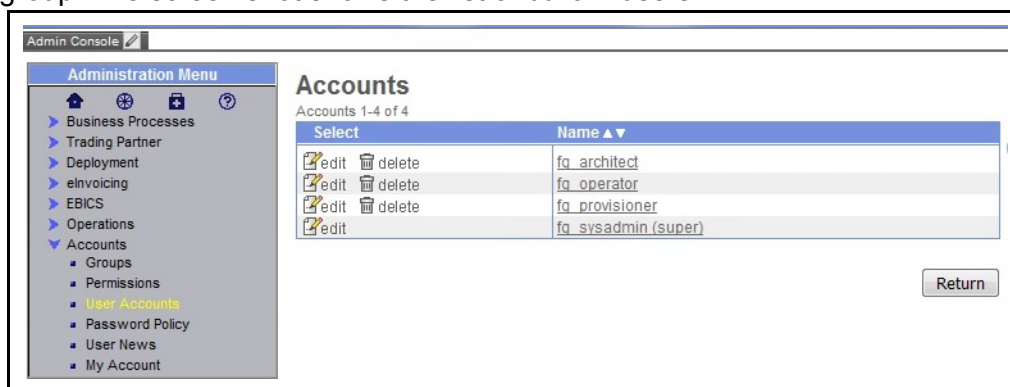
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User creation

Users of Sterling File Gateway can be created in Sterling File Gateway or Sterling B2B Integrator. By default, all users that are created in Sterling File Gateway are assigned to the following groups:

- Sterling File Gateway Partner Users
- Mailbox Browser Interface Users

To provide a user one of the administrative permissions, use the B2B Console to assign the user to appropriate group. The screen shot shows the list of built-in users.



Requirements

Participants must log in to Sterling File Gateway user interface with different user IDs such as fg_sysadmin, fg_operator, fg_provisioner and fg_architect to view different options and permissions provided to the users in Sterling File Gateway.

Communities

Introduction

A community represents a way to organize partners by protocol. In Sterling File Gateway, communities are used to limit or widen the selection of protocols available when creating partners. They are also used to allow listening or initiating modes of connection.

For example, you may have the following community categories:

- FTP
- SFTP
- HTTP
- Connect:Direct
- Listening
- Initiating

A community is required for partner creation in Sterling File Gateway. The community must exist before the partner is created. Integration Architects manage communities in Advanced File Transfer (AFT).



Note

Communities is a feature that was built into the Advanced File Transfer (AFT) product and was carried over into Sterling File Gateway. AFT is now Sterling File Gateway. Communities are limited in providing protocol organization. But, the feature has been retained as is, in Sterling File Gateway for various engineering reasons.

Groups

Introduction

Groups provide more flexibility than communities. Groups help a company to logically organize their partners according to the business needs of the company.

For example, you may have the following types of groups:

- Divisions or locations
- File types
- Protocol
- Encryption requirements

Upon installation of Sterling File Gateway, a group named *All Partners* is created. By default, each partner is automatically associated with the *All Partners* group when they are created in Sterling File Gateway. The *All Partners* group cannot be deleted.

Partners must be a member of at least one group. Partners can be a member of multiple groups.

Routing Channel Templates are limited to the producer and consumer groups that are configured to use the template. Assigning partners to groups allows the partners to participate in any transfers using templates where the group is specified.

You can delete groups that you create, unless they are currently being used in a routing channel template. First, delete the routing channel template, and then delete the group.



Note

Groups allow a company to organize their trading partners by business needs. A trading partner can exist in more than one group, which makes groups flexible and allows companies to get organized.

Communities are limited to providing protocol organization, both communities and groups provide partner organization.

Partners

Introduction

The following are some of the attributes of a partner in Sterling File Gateway:

- Sterling File Gateway helps in exchanging files between partners through routing channels that are set up to connect specific partners.
- Partners that send files into Sterling File Gateway are known as producers, and the partners that retrieve files are known as consumers.
- A partner can be a producer, a consumer, or both from an operational standpoint.
- Each partner is associated with one community.
- Before partners can be created, it is important that the System Administrator configure any communications adapters the partners need to use so that permissions are set correctly.

Communication

Sterling File Gateway uses the communication adapters in Sterling B2B Integrator to receive and send connections with partners for transferring files. These connections can use different Internet protocols, including FTP, FTPS, SFTP, SCP, Sterling Connect:Direct®, HTTP, HTTPS. Communication can also use security such as SFTP, PGP. For successful communication using SFTP and PGP, the following prerequisites have to be met:

SFTP communication

If a consumer partners use SFTP, you must create a remote SSH Profile before creating the partners.

PGP communication

If your partners use PGP communication, you must complete the following tasks before creating the partners:

- i. Install PGP server.
- ii. Start CLA2Client.jar process.
- iii. Modify PGPCmdlineService in Sterling B2B Integrator console.
- iv. Create a PGP Profile named AFTPGPPProfile in the Sterling B2B Integrator console.

Decryption of document received from partner:

Decryption is done based on the secret PGP key definition in the Community, where the partners are added. PGP keys will be decrypted in SFG based on the secret key defined for the community to which the partner belongs.

Encryption of document delivered to partner:

The PGP public key for a trading partner is defined in Sterling B2B Integrator first and then associated with the partner when on boarding the SFG partner. When SFG has to encrypt the document to be sent to the partner, SFG will look up the public key for the partner and use for the encryption before storing in the partner's mailbox.

Partners

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Creation

When a partner is created in Sterling File Gateway, the following objects are created to support the partner:

- A Sterling B2B Integrator user account.
 - A Sterling B2B Integrator mailbox using the partner name.
 - A Sterling B2B Integrator virtual root for the user and mailbox.
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Exercise 1.2.1: Community creation

Introduction

In this exercise, you will create a SFG community, SFG group for three partners and transfer files to the partners.

Instructions

Complete the following steps to create a community in Sterling File Gateway:

Step 1: From a web browser, access *http://192.168.40.100:9000/filegateway* URL.

Step 2: Specify **fg_sysadmin** as the user ID and **password** as password.

Step 3: From the main menu, select **Participants > Communities**. A new window opens.



Note

make sure that pop-up windows are enabled in the browser.

Step 4: Click **+add** to add the community.

Step 5: In the community name, enter **SFG** and click **Next**.

Step 6: From the Add Community: Protocol window. Set the following parameters:

Parameter	Value
Partner Initiates Protocol Connection to Mailbox	
Partner Listens for Protocol Connections	
FTP or FTPS	

Step 7: Click **Next**.

Step 8: From the Add Community: Notifications window. Specify the following parameters:

Parameter	Value
Should member partners receive notifications that they are subscribed to?	No

Step 9: Click **Next**.

Step 10: Click **Finish**. The system displays the message **Created Community Successfully**. You can now close the tab to close the window.

Exercise 1.2.2: Group creation

Introduction

In this exercise, you will create a SFG group for the three partners to perform file transfers.

Instructions

Complete the following steps to create a group:

Step 1: Log in to filegateway by specifying **fg_sysadmin** as the user ID and **password** as password.

Step 2: From the main menu, select **Participants > Groups**.

Step 3: Click **+Create**.

Step 4: From the Create a New Group pop-up window, specify the value for the following parameters:

Parameter	Value
Partner Group Name	SFG

Step 5: Click **Save**.

Step 6: The system displays the message **Created Group: SFG**. Click **OK**.

Exercise 1.2.3: Partner Creation

Introduction

In this exercise, you will create two partners. One partner represents incoming trading partner from the outside world (partner) and the other partner will be your company (abc). Both partners produce and consume data. Partner and abcde are trading partners in the business scenario.

Instructions

Complete the following steps to create partner:

Step 1: Log in to filegateway by specifying **fg_sysadmin** as the user ID and **password** as password.

Step 2: From the main menu, select **Participants > Partners**.

Step 3: Click **+Create**.

Step 4: From the Add Partner screen, select your Community from the dropdown list, **SFG**, and then click, **Next**.

Step 5: From the Add Partner: Information screen, specify the following parameters:

Parameter	Value
Partner Name:	partner
Partner Code:	<leave blank>
Address:	123 Main Street
City:	Ann Arbor
State:	MI
Postal Code:	48106
Phone:	734-930-7800
Country:	UNITED STATES
Time Zone:	(GMT-05:00) Eastern Time (US & Canada)
Email Address:	student1@ibm.com

Step 6: Click **Next**.

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Exercise 1.2.3: Partner Creation

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Instructions

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Step 7: From the **Add Partner: User Account** screen, specify the following parameters:



Note

Use the ID and password listed in the table to access the mailbox repository.

Parameter	Value
Authentication Type:	Local (Note: External is for LDAP password control)
User name:	partner
Password:	password
Confirm Password:	password
Password Policy:	<leave blank>
Authentication Host:	<leave blank>
Session Timeout:	30
Given Name:	Remote
Surname:	Partner

Step 8: Click **Next**.

Step 9: From the **Add Partner: Partner Role** screen, specify the following parameters:

Parameter	Value
Partner is a Consumer of Data:	☒
Partner will initiate the connection to consume data:	☒
Partner is a Producer of Data:	☒

Step 10: Click, **Next**.

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Exercise 1.2.3: Partner Creation

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Instructions

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Step 11: From the **Add Partner: Initiate Connection Settings** screen, specify the following parameter:

Parameter	Value
Will partner use either SSH/SFTP protocol to initiate connections?	No

Step 12: Click, **Next**.

Step 13: From the **PGP Settings** screen, specify the following parameters:

Parameter	Value
Does partner require data to be signed by the Router?	No
Does partner require data to be encrypted by the Router?	No

Step 14: Click, **Next**.

Step 15: Click, **Finish**.

Step 16: The system displays the message **Added Partner Successful**. Click **Return** and close the window.

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Exercise 1.2.3: Partner Creation

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Introduction

In this exercise, Abc company names the administrator user as *abcde*. you will create a partner *abcde* for Abc company.

Instructions

Complete the following steps to create abcde partner:

Step 1: Log in to filegateway with the ID of **fg_sysadmin**.

Step 2: From the main menu, select **Participants > Partners**.

Step 3: Click **+Create**.

Step 4: From the **Add Partner** screen, select your Community from the dropdown list, **SFG**, and then select, **Next**.

Step 5: From the **Add Partner: Information screen**, specify the following parameters:

Parameter	Value
Partner Name:	abcde
Partner Code:	<leave blank>
Address:	123 State Street
City:	Ann Arbor
State:	MI
Postal Code:	48106
Phone:	734-930-8000
Country:	UNITED STATES
Time Zone:	(GMT-05:00) Eastern Time (US & Canada)
Email Address:	student2@ibm.com

Step 6: Click **Next**.

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Exercise 1.2.3: Partner Creation

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Instructions

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Step 7: From the **Add Partner: User Account** screen, specify the following parameters: [**Note:** Use these credentials to access the mailbox repository.]

Parameter	Value
Authentication Type:	Local (Note: External is for LDAP password control)
User name:	abcde
Password:	password
Confirm Password:	password
Password Policy:	<leave blank>
Authentication Host:	<leave blank>
Session timeout:	30
Given Name:	ABCDE
Surname:	Company

Step 8: Click **Next**.

Step 9: From the **Add Partner: Partner Role** screen, specify the following parameters:

Parameter	Value
Partner is a Consumer of Data:	
Partner will initiate the connection to consume data:	
Partner is a Producer of Data:	

Step 10: Click **Next**.

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Exercise 1.2.3: Partner Creation

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Instructions

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Step 11: From the **Add Partner: Initiate Connection Settings** screen, specify the following parameters..

Parameter	Value
Will partner use either SSH/SFTP protocol to initiate connections?	No

Step 12: Click, **Next**

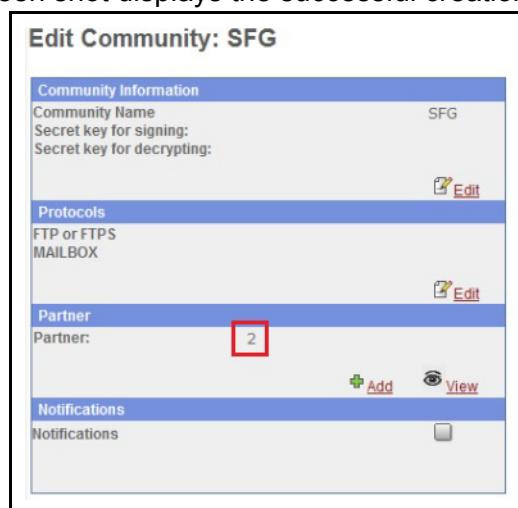
Step 13: From the **PGP Settings** screen, specify the following parameters:

Parameter	Value
Does partner require data to be signed by the Router?	No
Does partner require data to be encrypted by the Router?	No

Step 14: Click, **Next**.

Step 15: Click, **Finish**. The system displays the message **Added Partner Successful**.

Step 16: Click **Return**. The screen shot displays the successful creation of two partners..



Step 17: Close the window.

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Exercise 1.2.3: Partner Creation

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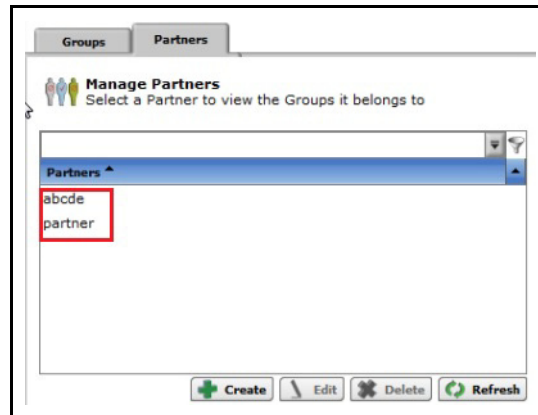
Instructions

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Complete the following steps to view the partners you created.

Step 1: From the main menu of filegateway, select **Participants > Partners**.

Step 2: On the **Partners** tab, click **Refresh** to view the list of partners. The screen shot displays the list of partners you created.



Exercise 1.2.4: Attaching a partner to a group

Introduction

In this exercise, you attach partners to the SFG group.

Instructions

Complete the following steps to attach a partner to a group:

Step 3: Log in to filegateway by specifying **fg_sysadmin** as the user ID and **password** as password.

Step 4: From the main menu, select **Participants > Groups**.

Step 5: **Select** your group (**SFG**) in the left panel.

Step 6: Click **Add Partners** in the right bottom corner of the screen.

Step 7: The window opens **Add Partners... Add Identities to Groups**.

Step 8: In the left panel, select **partner** and **abcde**



Note

As the partners to be attached to SFG group, To select multiple partners, use the control key and select the partner names from the list.

Step 9: In the right panel select **SFG** as the group and click **Execute**.

Step 10: The system displays a confirmation **Add Partners...** screen. Review the information and click **OK**, and close the window.

Lesson review

What you have been able to do

- Explain the importance of users in Sterling File Gateway.
 - List built in users of Sterling File Gateway.
 - Explain about communities, groups and trading partners.
 - Create communities, groups, partners and users.
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